The Clear Gateway to Research Compliance

Clargate: A Standardized Research Compliance Platform

THE PROBLEM

01

Hours lost to back-and-forth

IRB administrators spend 10+ hours per week coaching researchers on rewrites, chasing missing documents, and manually drafting revision letters. Time that should be spent on compliance is consumed by communication overhead.

02

Vague federal guidelines, inconsistent outcomes

Interpreting the Common Rule and OHRP guidance varies across reviewers and institutions, creating delays, errors, and compliance risk that no one is equipped to prevent.

03

Outdated, fragmented tools

Most institutions rely on legacy platforms built decades ago, supplemented by email threads, manual PDF exports, and spreadsheets. The infrastructure hasn't kept up with research volume.

KEY FIGURES

The opportunity: *A modern, AI-powered IRB platform priced accessibly for the 3,000+ smaller institutions currently using cobbled-together legacy tools.*

4,000+

IRB-registered institutions in the United States

100–2,000+

proposals processed per institution per year; every federally funded human subjects research project requires IRB approval

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$5K–$250K+/year

is what current platforms charge, and were built for large R1 research universities

THE SOLUTION

Clargate: One platform that makes every step of the IRB process clearer

01

AI Proposal Assistant

Guides researchers through submissions in real time, flags missing documents before they're submitted, and educates PIs on institutional and federal requirements as they go. Fewer incomplete submissions means less back-and-forth for admins.

02

Smart Admin Dashboard

Summarizes incoming proposals, surfaces the most critical information for reviewers, and automatically drafts revision request letters—reducing hours of manual work to minutes.

03

Institutional Benchmarking

Anonymously surfaces how peer institutions have categorized comparable proposals, giving administrators a broader frame of reference without compromising data privacy.

WHY NOW?

- **AI in the modern times**: Large language models can now summarize complex documents, flag regulatory gaps, and draft formal correspondence at a quality level that wasn't possible two years ago. Clargate is built on this capability, not retrofitting AI onto old infrastructure.

- **Legacy platforms are losing ground**: IRBNet, Cayuse, and Kuali were built for a different era. Institutions are actively looking for alternatives (eg. the University of Maryland just replaced IRBNet with Kuali in 2026, signaling that even entrenched platforms are vulnerable to displacement).

- **Research volume is growing, staff is not**: Every administrator interviewed described being understaffed relative to submission volume. The workload is increasing; the workforce isn't. Software that multiplies admin capacity is now more than ever operationally necessary.

TRACTION

1. 20+ IRB offices interviewed across the United States (including USC, UCSD, Baylor University, Texas A&M, Cedars-Sinai, University of San Diego, CSU Fresno, Occidental College, California Lutheran University, University of Redlands, Pitzer College, UCSB, UCSC, and more)
2. 100% of administrators interviewed confirmed the three core pain points unprompted
3. Active follow-up conversations ongoing with multiple institutions exploring design partner relationships

Key insight from discovery:
Identified the exact 5-step procurement chain at target institutions: IRB Admin → IRB Chair → Sponsored Programs Director → Provost → OIT — informing go-to-market strategy from day one.

THE COMPETITION

	Clargate	IRBNet	Cayuse	Kuali	Smartsheet
Built for IRB	✓	✓	Partial	Partial	✗
AI-powered	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Affordable for small institutions	✓	Partial	✗	✗	Partial
Modern UI	✓	✗	Partial	✗	✓
PI guidance built-in	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Institutional benchmarking	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗

BUSINESS MODEL

Pricing model:

- Annual site license per institution: one contract covers all users (admins, PIs, reviewers)
- No per-seat fees, no per-submission fees: predictable cost that institutions can budget for

3 Pricing Tiers (TBD)

- Small Institutions
- Medium Sized
- Large

Solution	Cost Range	Notes
IRBNet	~$5K–$30K/yr	usage-based, unpredictable
Cayuse	~$30K–$150K+/yr	enterprise, complex
Kuali	~$50K–$200K+/yr	large R1 only
Clargate	$8K–$22K/yr	modern & affordable